

Kuhn's Scientific Paradigm Simulation

This project aims to visualize the concept of Kuhn's theory of paradigm shifts. It does so by imagining scientists and their beliefs as squares that interact with each other. When the user 'introduces a new thought', one of the squares changes its beliefs and has a chance to convince its fellow squares when they bump into them. At the top of the screen, you can see which phase of Kuhn's cycle is being emulated:

- Normal Science: Scientists work within an established paradigm.
- Anomaly Introduction: A contradiction to the existing paradigm is found.
- Model Drift: Anomalies start to accumulate, raising doubt amongst some scientists.
- Model Crisis: There is too much the existing paradigm cannot explain. The field is in chaos and new theoretic models are needed.
- Model Revolution: The new models appear to explain the state of the field better than the previous ones.
- Paradigm Shift: A single model prevails as the most appropriate and is adopted as the new paradigm.

In the bottom right corner, you can view the history of all paradigms that were, at one point, considered the most logical.

The golden centre represents the established scientific consensus as a sort of deity, emulating the way scientists are generally supposed not to question the current paradigm.

The icons used were made by Aranagraphics and were downloaded from Flaticon.